Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.
OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.
2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand
3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand
2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦K

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦3

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣Q

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♠7

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥J

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A K 9
♥ A K 2
♦ A 8 3
♣ A J 7 4

♠ J 10 6 5 3
♥ 10 8 3
♦ 5
♣ Q 10 8 2



♠ Q 4
♥ Q J 9 6
♦ K Q 10 9 7
♣ K 6

♠ 8 7 2
♥ 7 5 4
♦ J 6 4 2
♣ 9 5 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2NT		
All Pass			

2NT by North
Lead: ♦K

NORTH has a perfect hand for an opening bid of 2♣. 23 points and balanced distribution is just fine.

SOUTH is glad to hear his partner has lots of points, because he was shortchanged. However, he must answer, so with 1 point he bids a negative 2♦.

NORTH describes her hand by saying 2NT. SOUTH does not have to bid the double negative over a 2NT bid, so he passes.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ Q J 4 ♥ 9 4 3 ♦ 5 2 ♣ A J 8 6 3	
♠ K 7 3 ♥ Q 8 2 ♦ 10 9 8 6 ♣ 5 4 2		♠ A 8 2 ♥ A K 7 5 ♦ K Q J ♣ K Q 10
	♠ 10 9 6 5 ♥ J 10 6 ♦ A 7 4 3 ♣ 9 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
2♦	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			

3NT by East
Lead: ♦3

EAST has a balanced hand with 22 points. He opens 2♣.

WEST, with 5 points, must respond ♦. Both these bids are artificial.

EAST now describes his hand by bidding 2NT. WEST bids 3NT, knowing that the partnership holds at least 27 points.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ Q J 10 7 2 ♥ A 5 ♦ 7 4 2 ♣ 6 5 3	
♠ 9 4 ♥ 9 3 ♦ 6 5 3 ♣ Q J 9 8 7 2	N W E S	♠ A 8 6 5 ♥ 10 8 7 6 4 ♦ K J 10 ♣ 10
	♠ K 3 ♥ K Q J 2 ♦ A Q 9 8 ♣ A K 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South
Lead: ♣Q

SOUTH opens 2♣ with her balanced 22 points.

NORTH has 8 points AND a 5-card ♠ suit. This is strong enough for a positive response, so he bids 2♠.

SOUTH completes the description of her hand by saying 2NT.

NORTH does NOT rebid the ♠s; his first bid already promised a 5-card suit. He just bids 3NT.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 9 8 7 4 ♥ J 4 ♦ Q 10 5 ♣ K J 5 3	
♠ K Q 2 ♥ A K Q 7 5 ♦ A 7 2 ♣ A 10		♠ A 3 ♥ 10 9 8 2 ♦ 9 8 6 ♣ 8 7 6 4
	♠ J 10 6 5 ♥ 6 3 ♦ K J 4 3 ♣ Q 9 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2♣	Pass	2♦	Pass
2♥	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			

4♥ by West
Lead: ♠7

WEST has 23 points and opens 2♣.

EAST, with 4 points, must respond 2♦.

WEST now shows a ♥ suit (at least 5) by bidding 2♥.

EAST likes ♥s, she has already told WEST she has fewer than 8 points, so she bids 4♥.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A J 8 7 ♥ A K ♦ A 8 6 ♣ A K Q J	
♠ 10 9 3 ♥ Q 8 4 2 ♦ K J 10 9 ♣ 8 2		♠ K 5 4 ♥ J 10 6 ♦ 7 4 3 ♣ 10 7 6 4
	♠ Q 6 2 ♥ 9 7 5 3 ♦ Q 5 2 ♣ 9 5 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North
Lead: ♥J

NORTH has lots of points - 26 to be exact. She opens 2♣. In the old days this hand would have been opened 3NT.

SOUTH has 4 points and responds 2♦.

NORTH now shows her full strength by jumping to 3NT (25-27 points, balanced).

SOUTH knows there is no slam, so he passes 3NT.